

Eleonora Minaeva

CONTACT INFORMATION	<i>Mobile:</i> +39 351 519 2429 <i>Web-page:</i> eleonora-minaeva.com <i>Email:</i> eleonora.minaeva@eui.eu
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Subnational Politics and Decentralization; Electoral Institutions and Accountability; Political Economy of Governance; Post-Soviet and Eurasian Politics; Survey Experiments and Causal Inference.
EDUCATION	European University Institute, Florence, Italy Ph.D. in Political Science 2022–present Department of Political and Social Sciences • Thesis: <i>Political (De)Centralization Under Authoritarianism</i> European University at St.Petersburg, St. Petersburg, Russia Master of Political Science, Department of Political Science 2018–2020 • Thesis: <i>Factors of Electoral Mobilization at the Local Level in Russia: 2016–2018</i> • GPA: 3.95 Perm State University, Perm, Russia Master of International Relationships, Department of Political Science 2017–2019 • Thesis: <i>The Influence of European Urban Practices on Coalition Interactions in the Largest Russian Cities</i> • GPA: 4.0 Bachelor of Political Science, Department of Political Science 2013–2017 • Thesis: <i>Ethnic Territorial Autonomies: The Problem of Political Space Segmentation</i> • GPA: 3.96
ACADEMIC POSITIONS	European University Institute, Florence, Italy PhD Researcher, Department of Political and Social Sciences 2022–present Center for Comparative History and Political Studies, Russia Research Fellow September 2020–June 2022
VISITING POSITIONS	Institute for European, Russian and Eurasian Studies (IERES), George Washington University, Washington DC, USA Visiting Scholar January 2025–May 2025
PUBLICATIONS	[1] Serebrennikov D., Minaeva E., Ross S. (2026) Surveillance as Governance: Policing Effectiveness and Political Control in the Moscow AI Experiment. <i>Forthcoming in Russian Politics</i>. [2] Kostelka F., Alberdi M., Bradley M., Fiselier T., Jabbour A., Mansour-N., Minaeva E., Porciuleanu S., Rafailova D. (2026) Mass Attitudes towards Russia's Aggression against Ukraine: Tentative Support for Top-Down Opinion Formation <i>Forthcoming in European Journal of Political Research</i>.

- [3] Minaeva E., Rumiantseva A., Zavadskaya M. (2023) From local elections to appointments: How has municipal reform changed vote delivery in Russian municipalities? *Electoral Studies*, Vol. 85, DOI:10.1016/j.electstud.2023.102657.
- [4] Minaeva E. (2023) Policy Activism in Urban Governance: The Case of Master Plan Development in Perm. in Jeremy Morris, Andrei Semenov and Regina Smyth (Ed.) *Varieties of Russian Activism: State-Society Contestation in Everyday Life*. Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
- [5] Minaeva E. (2022) Strategies for the Preservation and Cancellation of the Direct Election of Municipal Heads in Russia. *Universe of Russia. Sociology. Ethnology*, Vol. 31, Issue 2: 97-117. (in Russian)
- [6] Minaeva E., Panov P. (2021) Dense Networks, Ethnic Minorities, and Electoral Mobilization in Contemporary Russia. *Problems of Post-Communism*, DOI:10.1080/10758216.2021.1974885.
- [7] Minaeva E., Panov P. (2020) Localization of Ethnic Groups in the Regions as a Factor of Cross-Regional Variations in Voting for United Russia. *Russian Politics*: 131-153.
- [8] Minaeva E., Semenov A. (2020) The Cities of Forking Streets: Trajectories of Urban Conflicts in Russia. *The Journal of Social Policy Studies*, Vol. 19, Issue 2: 189-204. (in Russian)
- [9] Minaeva E., Semenov A. (2020) Policy Transfer in Urban Governance: The Case of Strategic Urban Planning in Russia. *Ars Administrandi*, Vol. 1: 120-136. (in Russian)
- [10] Minaeva E., Panov. P. (2017) Ethnic Regional Autonomies: Variation of the Correlation Between Sub-State Boundaries and Ethnic Groups' Settlements. *Political Science*, Vol. 4: 178-205. (in Russian)
- [11] Minaeva E. (2016) Urban Settlement Versus Municipal District» in the Context of Vertical Power Structure: Polycentricity in Local Polity. *Bulletin of Perm University. Political Science*, Vol. 1: 83-96. (in Russian)

WORKING PAPERS *Solo-authored*

- [1] Minaeva E. Citizens' Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia.
- [2] Minaeva E. Why Autocrats (De)centralize Electoral Authority: Explaining the Introduction and Cancellation of Subnational Elections.

Co-authored

- [3] Minaeva E., Melnikov K., Hazell T. Local Elections and Elite Management in Authoritarian Regimes: Evidence from Kazakhstan.
- [4] Minaeva E., Melnikov K., Hazell T. The Governance Effects of Local Elections in Autocracies: Evidence from a Natural Experiment in Kazakhstan.

ONLINE PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Rogov K., & Minaeva E. (2022) The Journey from 1945 to 1941 [\[Link\]](#)
- [2] Minaeva E. (2018) GIS Technologies in Ethno-Political Studies: Spatial Localization of Ethnic Groups [\[Link\]](#)

RESEARCH PROJECTS AND COLLABORATIONS

Maidan Revolutions, the War in Ukraine, and Civil Society Responses [\[Project link\]](#)

- Design and implementation of cross-national survey research in **Armenia, Belarus, Russia, and Ukraine**, including questionnaire development, coordination with survey firms, and data analysis.

GLOBAL — European Governance and Politics Programme (ERC Advanced Grant)
[Project link]

- Data collection and validation on transnational party networks; development of datasets for evaluating large language models (LLMs).

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

- Instructor**, TU Darmstadt, Darmstadt, Germany Fall 2024; Fall 2025
- Political Paths of Post-Soviet Countries (MA level, block seminar)
- Instructor**, European University Institute, Florence, Italy 2023
- Introduction to R (PhD level)
- Teaching Assistant**, Perm State University, Perm, Russia 2020–2022
- Comparative Politics
 - Methodology of Political Science
 - R Programming
 - Regional Studies

SKILLS AND
LANGUAGES

- Methods:**
- Causal inference with observational data (panel and cross-sectional)
 - Quasi-experimental designs (including difference-in-differences)
 - Survey and vignette experiments; questionnaire design
 - Multilevel and regression analysis
- Programming and Tools:**
- R&R Studio (Advanced), STATA (Intermediate), Python (Beginner)
 - L^AT_EX (Advanced), ArcGIS/ArcMap (Intermediate)
 - Large language models (LLMs) for data collection and validation (Intermediate)
- Languages:**
- Russian: native
 - English: advanced
 - Italian: conversational (A2-B1)

ACADEMIC
LEADERSHIP AND
SERVICE

- Researchers' Representative 2024–2025
Department of Political and Social Sciences, European University Institute

GRANTS

- European University Institute — Early Stage Researchers Grant 2024–2025
Local Elections and Elite Management in Authoritarian Regimes: Evidence from Kazakhstan
- Russian Science Foundation 2018–2023
Collective Grant
Mechanisms of Interests Coordination in the Urban Development Processes

	Oxford Russia Fellowship Individual Grant <i>Political Consequences of the Implementation of Municipal Heads' Appointments in Russia</i>	2020–2021
	Russian Foundation for Basic Research Collective Grant <i>Spatial Localization of Ethnic Minorities within the Framework of Political-Administrative Boundaries as a Factor of Politicization of Ethnicity on Sub-National Level: Russian Practices in the Context of World Experience</i>	2019–2021
	Volkswagen Foundation Collective Grant for Interdisciplinary and International Research <i>Shifting Paradigms: Towards Participatory and Effective Urban Planning in Germany, Russia and Ukraine</i>	2019–2021
	Russian Science Foundation Collective Grant for Russian Scholars <i>Securing a Balance in Interethnic Relations: Regional autonomies, the State Integrity and the Rights of Ethnic Minorities</i>	2015–2017
LATEST CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOP TALKS	Political Behaviour Colloquium, March 10, 2026 Paper: <i>Citizens' Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia</i> MPSA, Politics and Political Economy of Eurasia Workshop, April 23-26, 2025, Chicago Paper: <i>Local Elections and Elite Management: Evidence from Kazakhstan, co-authored with Kirill Melnikov and Thomas Hazell</i> The Russia Program Annual Conference, April 18, 2025, Washington DC Paper: <i>Russian Centralization in the Global Authoritarian Context</i> Pre-EPSA Conference on Authoritarian Politics, July 3, 2024, Cologne Paper: <i>Legitimacy Erosion and State Capacity: Explaining Political (De)Centralization in Dictatorships</i> Building Closed Autocracies: the Cases of Russia and Belarus, October 6-7, 2022, Berlin Paper: <i>Non-Programmatic Electoral Mobilization of Ethnic Minorities: Evidence from Russia</i> 5th Annual Tartu Conference on Russian and East European Studies, June 6-8, 2021 Paper: <i>From Elections to Appointments: Does Centralization Strengthen Political Support? Evidence from the Russian Municipalities</i> ASN Annual World Convention, May 6-8, 2021 Paper: <i>Political Consequences of the Implementation of Municipal Heads' Appointments in Russia</i> St. Petersburg Conference on Inequality and Diversity, October 21-22, 2019 Paper: <i>Machine Politics at the Local Level in Russia at the Present Stage</i> RC21 Delhi conference "In and Beyond the City: Emerging Ontologies, Persistent Challenges and Hopeful Futures", September 18-21, 2019 Paper: <i>Citizen-State Interactions in Urban Planning in Russian Cities</i>	